

TRENT PUBLICATIONS PRESENTS

DEAD PLANTS

SOME GAMES AREN'T MEANT TO BE PLAYED.

· EXE ·

Deadplants.exe - The Horror of the Unseen

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Preface

In the world of gaming, a simple download can lead to unforeseen horrors. Deadplants.exe takes the beloved universe of Plants vs. Zombies and twists it into a nightmare where innocence is corrupted, and shadows come alive. This story follows Alex, an unsuspecting player who unwittingly awakens a dark force that blurs the line between reality and a corrupted game. As he battles both sinister plants and his own fears, he discovers that some games should never be played. Dive into this chilling tale, where the cheerful garden transforms into a haunting battleground, and the stakes are higher than ever before.

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Chapter 1

The Download

The glow of the computer screen bathed Alex's room in a soft light, casting long shadows that danced across the walls. A dedicated fan of Plants vs. Zombies, Alex found solace in the game's whimsical characters and strategy-based gameplay. It was a simple escape from the stresses of school and everyday life. One fateful evening, while browsing a forum dedicated to gaming mods, he stumbled upon a thread discussing a mysterious file: Deadplants.exe. The name sent a shiver down his spine, yet curiosity tugged at him. The download link led to a website with a dark, foreboding design. Despite the unsettling aura, the comments beneath the post were filled with praise and excitement. "It's unlike anything you've ever played," one user wrote. "Just be prepared for the horror!" The words echoed in his mind, a warning he brushed aside in favour of adventure. After a moment of hesitation, Alex clicked the link and initiated the download. The file size was surprisingly small, a mere fraction of what he expected from a game. Intrigued, he watched the progress bar fill. As it completed, a chilling gust of wind rattled the window, making him jump. He shook off the feeling of unease, convinced it was just his imagination. After the installation, the screen flickered to life with a loading screen that resembled the classic Plants vs. Zombies theme. But something felt off. The cheerful music was replaced with a dissonant, glitchy tune that sent a chill down his spine. He hesitated for a moment, glancing at the ominous title: Deadplants.exe. He took a deep breath and pressed "Start." The first level began, displaying a familiar garden, yet the colours were muted, washed out. As the first wave of zombies appeared, Alex's heart raced with



excitement. But the familiar Peashooters and Sunflowers had a twisted appearance; their eyes were hollow, and their smiles were replaced with gnarled frowns. The plants moved sluggishly, as if resisting the urge to



come to life. Despite his unease, Alex pushed through the level, drawn in by the gameplay. However, the further he progressed, the more he noticed oddities. Glitches appeared, with the graphics flickering and distorting. The characters muttered words that made no sense, their voices low and menacing. The whimsical nature of the game had

devolved into something dark and sinister. The final wave of zombies came charging at him, but they were not like the



goofy, slow-moving undead he was used to. These zombies were grotesque, with jagged teeth and hollow eyes. They screamed and lunged at him, their movements erratic and unnatural. He felt a cold sweat break out on his

forehead. Just as he was about to lose, the screen flashed red, and a chilling message appeared: "You shouldn't have downloaded this." The words sent a jolt of fear through him. He tried to exit the game, but the cursor froze. Panic surged as he clicked frantically, but the game held him captive. Shadows crept along the walls of his room, and for the first time, he felt the weight of the darkness that surrounded him.

Chapter 2

The Game Begins

The atmosphere in Alex's room shifted dramatically. As he fought against the chaotic screen, shadows danced along the edges of his vision, almost as if the darkness itself had come alive. Finally, with a flicker of hope, the game quit, but the tension in the air remained thick, like the calm before a storm. Taking a moment to breathe, Alex shook off the eerie feeling. He turned to his phone, hoping to distract himself with a few messages. But as he typed, a low whisper echoed through his room. "Play again," it hissed, chilling him to the bone. He glanced around, but saw nothing. Just the flickering light of his computer screen and the walls, still shadowed in an unsettling darkness. Ignoring the voice, he tried to convince himself it was just a figment of his imagination. Yet, when he glanced back at the screen, he noticed the game had restarted itself. The title `Deadplants.exe` shimmered with a faint red glow, as if beckoning him to return. Hesitantly, he clicked "Start" again, heart pounding in his chest. This time, the garden appeared even more twisted. The sunflowers looked emaciated, their petals drooping, while the Peashooters' faces were marked with anguish. "What is happening?" he muttered to himself, feeling a surge of dread. As the zombies surged forward, Alex's movements became mechanical. He placed the plants in a frantic attempt to fend off the grotesque undead. But each time he thought he was gaining ground, the plants shrivelled up and died, their lifeless forms collapsing as the zombies pushed through. The cheerful sound effects of plants firing were replaced with disturbing screams, filling his head with a sense of despair. The darkness in the game began to bleed into his reality. Shadows flickered at the edges of his vision, and whispers of laughter echoed ominously. He felt a presence looming behind him, an unshakeable feeling that he was not alone. The whispers grew louder, almost mocking him, "You're losing, Alex. You can't escape." Panic surged again, but he fought to maintain

focus. He frantically clicked on the screen, trying to place his last few plants. Yet, as he did, the screen flashed with images of distorted, mangled plants, grotesque versions of the beloved characters he had cherished. Their eyes glowed red, and twisted smiles stretched across their faces. The cheerful garden had morphed into a landscape of horror. As he reached the final wave, the screen went black. The dissonant music stopped abruptly, leaving a heavy silence. Then, a chilling voice boomed from the speakers: "Welcome to your nightmare." Alex's heart raced. He felt the shadows grow more substantial, creeping closer to him, and the realisation struck him like a bolt of lightning—he had awakened something terrible. Just as he was about to quit the game again, a sudden jolt of electricity coursed through his fingers. He couldn't look away as the screen flickered back to life, displaying the twisted garden and the looming darkness.



Chapter 3

The Haunting

The next few days blurred together as Alex struggled to shake off the suffocating dread that had settled over him. The whispers from the game haunted his every thought, echoing in his mind like a relentless reminder of his mistake. It was as if the game had seeped into his very being, tainting everything he once loved about Plants vs. Zombies. He found it hard to concentrate at school. The laughter of his friends felt distant, and the once-comforting sound of the school bell rang with an ominous tone. At home, the shadows in his room seemed to deepen, moving and twisting in the corners of his vision. Each creak of the floorboards sent shivers down his spine, reminding him of the suffocating atmosphere within the game. One evening, as he sat at his desk, a strange rustling sound pulled him from his thoughts. He turned, expecting to see a cat or perhaps a stray leaf caught in the breeze. Instead, he was met with an unsettling sight: the plants in his small garden outside appeared wilted and decayed, their once-vibrant colours replaced with a sickly grey. A chill ran down his spine as he realised they mirrored the corrupted plants from the game. "Get it together," he muttered, shaking his head. But the unease crept back in, a gnawing feeling that something was wrong. Later that night, he tried to sleep, but sleep eluded him. He lay wide awake, staring at the ceiling, the faint glow of his computer screen illuminating the dark corners of his room. As he struggled to find rest, whispers filled the air, growing louder and more insistent. "You shouldn't have played," they taunted. "You're ours now." Alex bolted upright, heart racing, and glanced around his room. Shadows flickered against the walls, twisting into familiar shapes—the silhouettes of Peashooters and Sunflowers, their eyes glowing red with malevolence. Panicking, he dashed to his window, peering out into the night. The garden was silent, but the air felt thick with dread. He thought he saw movement, a shadow flitting between the plants, but when he blinked,

it was gone. Shaking, he returned to his desk and opened his laptop, desperately seeking clarity. The screen flickered to life, the Deadplants.exe icon pulsating ominously. Against his better judgement, he clicked it open. The game started anew, the familiar loading screen tainted by an unsettling aura. The moment the first level appeared, he was met with an even darker twist—the characters on screen now bore his likeness, grotesque caricatures with twisted features, mocking his every move. "Welcome back," the disembodied voice echoed, chilling him to the bone. Shadows danced in his peripheral vision as he gripped the mouse tightly, the whispers growing louder, taunting him. "Play with us, Alex. Forever."



Chapter 4

Confrontation

After days of torment, Alex could no longer ignore the darkness that enveloped him. The whispers and shadows were suffocating, urging him to confront the twisted game that had invaded his life. Driven by fear and determination, he resolved to face whatever horror Deadplants.exe had unleashed. One evening, he prepared himself, setting up his computer with trembling hands. As he opened the game, a wave of dread washed over him. The familiar loading screen materialised, but it felt different—more oppressive. The moment the game loaded, the screen filled with chaotic imagery of grotesque plants and zombies, their twisted forms flickering with malice. "Are you ready, Alex?" the voice taunted, echoing throughout the room. He took a deep breath, steeling himself against the suffocating fear. He needed to confront this nightmare. As he navigated through the levels, the game grew increasingly chaotic. The plants he had once cherished were now malevolent, their faces contorted in agony. The Peashooters fired with fury, but their shots were blackened and corrupted, missing the zombies and instead hitting the innocent flowers surrounding them. Each level felt like a descent into madness, the darkness closing in around him. Suddenly, the game shifted. The screen flickered and warped, the landscape transforming into a haunting representation of his own home. The dark figure that had loomed over him in nightmares materialised, a shadowy presence with glowing red eyes that pierced through the darkness. "You think you can escape?" it growled, its voice a low rumble. Alex's heart raced as he realised this was the entity that haunted him, the dark force behind the game. He felt a surge of defiance as he replied, "I won't let you control me!" The figure lunged forward, and the room around him seemed to distort. Shadows extended from the figure's limbs, creeping toward him like tendrils, wrapping around his body. Panic set in as he struggled against the darkness, but it felt as if it were seeping

into his very being. Determined, he focused on the screen, using the power of the game to fight back. "I won't play your game!" he shouted, clicking furiously to deploy every plant he had at his disposal. The Peashooters began to fire, their shots illuminating the shadows, pushing back against the dark figure. For every wave of zombies it sent forth, he retaliated with a relentless barrage of corrupted plants, their twisted forms battling against the darkness. Each moment felt like a battle for his soul, the lines between the game and reality blurring as the shadows closed in. The darkness roared, shaking the room. "You cannot win! This is your fate!" The malevolence surged, but Alex's resolve hardened. He gripped the mouse tightly, summoning every ounce of strength. With a final, desperate click, he unleashed a wave of blinding light from the plants, illuminating the darkness around him. The figure shrieked as the light engulfed it, forcing it back into the depths of the screen. Alex felt a rush of triumph as he realised he could fight back, that he had the power to resist.

Chapter 5

The Escape

With the dark figure momentarily subdued, Alex felt a surge of determination. The game flickered wildly, the corrupted plants and zombies merging into a swirling chaos. He understood that he had to end this once and for all. The battle raged on, the whispers growing louder, threatening to drown him in despair. He focused on the screen, desperately trying to navigate through the chaos. "You can't keep me trapped here!" he shouted, channelling every ounce of strength he had left. The landscape twisted and morphed, the once-familiar garden now a hellish realm of shadows and decay. The corrupted zombies surged forward, but Alex was relentless. He deployed his last plants, their twisted forms battling fiercely against the undead horde. The tension in the room escalated as shadows swirled around him, pressing in with every passing moment. The dark figure reemerged, its eyes glowing with fury. "You will regret this, Alex!" it snarled, launching itself at him with malevolent intent. He felt the weight of its presence, an overwhelming force threatening to consume him. Just as the figure lunged, a sudden burst of inspiration struck. "Delete!" he shouted, recalling the brief moment of clarity he had felt earlier. He fumbled for the keyboard, typing furiously to navigate to the game's settings, trying to find the option to delete Deadplants.exe. The shadows writhed around him, and the whispers turned into a cacophony of rage. "You can't escape us!" they screamed, but he refused to succumb to fear. With a final, desperate click, he pressed "Delete." The screen flashed red, the words "Are you sure?" glaring back at him. The dark figure lunged closer, but Alex stood firm, heart pounding. "Yes!" he shouted, the word echoing in the confines of his mind. As he confirmed the deletion, a blinding light erupted from the screen, engulfing the room. The shadows screamed, their cries echoing in his ears. The dark figure writhed in agony as the light consumed it, and Alex felt the oppressive weight of the

darkness lifting. Suddenly, the screen went black. Silence enveloped him, and for a brief moment, he believed he had escaped. But as the darkness faded, he felt an unsettling emptiness in the air.

Chapter 6

The Aftermath

The silence in the room was deafening. Alex sat motionless at his desk, the remnants of Deadplants.exe fading from the screen. He felt an overwhelming sense of relief wash over him, but it was quickly replaced by a gnawing anxiety. Had he truly escaped? As the days passed, he tried to return to normal life, but the shadows still lingered at the edges of his vision. The garden outside his window remained wilting, the once-vibrant colours replaced by a dull, lifeless grey. Every time he glanced outside, he felt a sense of dread wash over him, a reminder of the darkness he had faced. At school, laughter and chatter filled the hallways, but Alex felt isolated. His friends were oblivious to the horror he had experienced, and he couldn't bring himself to share his story. He feared they wouldn't understand, that they might think he was losing his mind. One night, unable to sleep, he stared at the ceiling, remembering the twisted plants and the dark figure. The whispers echoed in his mind, "You're ours now." He shook his head, trying to banish the thoughts. He had fought against the darkness, and he had won, or so he thought. That evening, he dared to step outside into the garden. The air was heavy, and the chill of the night seeped into his bones. As he stepped closer to the wilted plants, he caught a glimpse of movement—a shadow flitting between the rows of flowers. He froze, heart pounding, and squinted into the darkness. A familiar silhouette emerged, the twisted form of a Peashooter, its eyes glowing with a malevolent light. It stood there, motionless, as if waiting for him. Alex's heart raced as panic set in. "No, this can't be happening!" he gasped, backing away. But as he retreated, he felt an icy grip on his heart, the realisation dawned on him: the game had left its mark, the darkness was not gone; it had merely transformed. He stumbled back inside, slamming the door shut, the whispers creeping back into his mind, taunting him. With a sense of dread settling over him, he locked the door and closed the curtains, but

the weight of the darkness still lingered. As he lay in bed, the shadows in his room twisted and shifted, whispering promises of a new nightmare. "Play with us, forever," they echoed. He felt a cold sweat break out as he realised the true horror—the game was never truly gone. The darkness had seeped into his life, and there was no escaping its grasp. As he closed his eyes, he understood the haunting truth: he might have deleted Deadplants.exe, but the game had won, and the darkness would always be with him. The screen went black and said, "Some games aren't meant to be played." Before the laptop got corrupted.

Editor's Note

Thank you for joining Alex on this chilling journey through the twisted world of *Deadplants.exe*. We hope that this story has sparked your imagination and evoked the thrill of adventure intertwined with the haunting elements of horror. In a universe where beloved games can turn dark, it's a reminder of the thin line between playfulness and dread.

As you close this book, we invite you to reflect on the stories that linger long after the last page. Whether they haunt your dreams or spark your creativity, every tale has the power to shape our perceptions. Keep exploring, stay curious, and remember—sometimes, the darkest corners of our imagination hold the most captivating stories.

Until next time, happy reading!

- Harold Seth

Editor in Chief

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Credits

Thankings To:

Vibingleaf for the Inspiration.

Original Video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UTYywFbdvBY>

Creator Channel:

<https://www.youtube.com/@vibingleaf>

Analysis Video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C8n45kxkFnk&t=77s>

Creator Channel:

https://www.youtube.com/@Raymundo_2112

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Thank you to all the readers as well.